



PARISHRAM 2027

Lost Spring I -
Sometimes I Find A
Rupee In The Garbage

Lecture - 4 Class 12

By Anurag Tyagi Sir



Topics to be Covered

1 Warm-up Game

2 Lost Spring I : Sometimes I find a Rupee in the Garbage

3 Exercise and Quiz





ARCADE

GAME TIME

Personification

Choose the correct pairs.

1 - b



a. The flowers were begging for water.

2 - c



b. The leaves were dancing on the lawn.

3 - a



c. The sun was peeking behind the clouds.

Choose the correct pairs.

4 - b



d. My alarm clock yelled at me to wake up.

5 - f



e. The fire ran wild.

6 - d



f. Good news travels fast.

Correct Pairings:

1



b. The leaves were dancing on the lawn.

2



c. The sun was peeking behind the clouds.

3



a. The flowers were begging for water.

Correct Pairings:

4



e. The fire ran wild.

5



f. Good news travels fast.

6



d. My alarm clock yelled at me to wake up.

His constant lies put his credibility in jeopardy.

A) Mystery

B) Competition

C) Distraction

☒ D) Danger

The event was supposed to happen next week, but they had to call it off due to the storm.

- A) They discussed it in a meeting.
- B) They postponed it by a few hours.
- ✓ C) They cancelled the event entirely.
- D) They moved it to a different venue.



Lost Spring -

Stories of Stolen Childhood

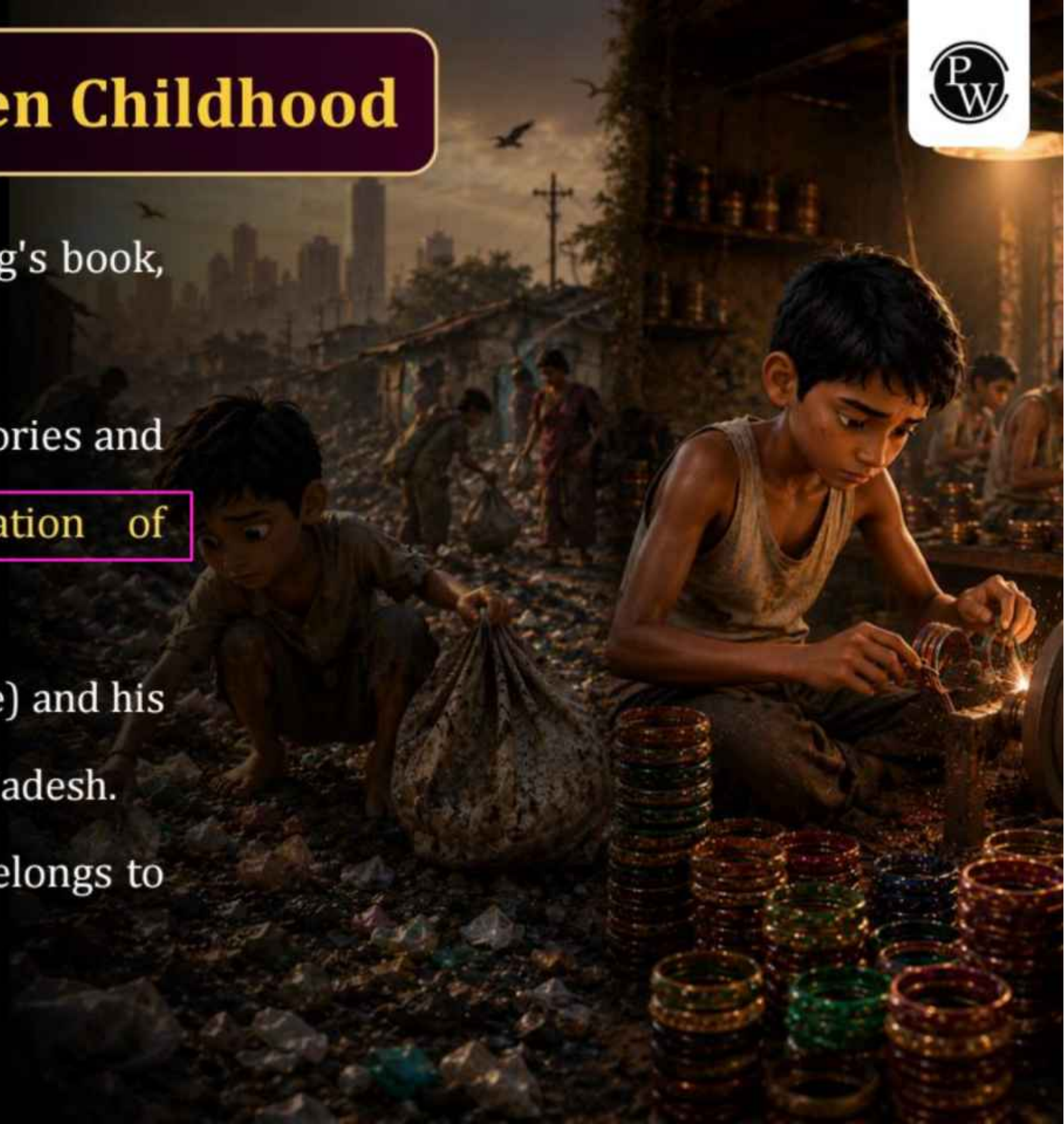
— by Anees Jung —



Lost Spring - Stories of Stolen Childhood



- "Lost Spring" is an extract from Anees Jung's book, 'Lost Spring, Stories of Stolen Childhood'.
- The author tells two real life experience stories and expresses concern about the exploitation of children in hazardous jobs.
 - One is about Saheb, a boy (in his teen age) and his family of ragpickers migrated from Bangladesh.
 - Another is the story of Mukesh who belongs to family of bangle makers.



About the Author - "Anees Jung"

- Anees Jung (1964) was born in Rourkela and spent her childhood and adolescence in Hyderabad.
- She received her education in Hyderabad and in the United States of America.
- She has been an editor and columnist for major newspapers in India and abroad, and has authored several books.

One of her notable works is "Lost Spring: Stories of Stolen Childhood," a collection of short stories that delves into the harsh realities faced by underprivileged children in India, particularly those caught in the cycle of child labor.



An illustration of a slum environment where children are scavenging for money. In the center, a boy holds up a 10 Indian Rupee note. Other children are seen in the background and foreground, some crouching and looking through trash. The scene is set under a makeshift shelter with laundry hanging from the roof. A dog is visible on the left, and a sack labeled 'DAILY' is on the right. The overall tone is somber and highlights the economic struggles of the community.

Sometimes I Find a Rupee in The Garbage

“Why do you do this?”

I ask Saheb whom I ^{meet by chance} encounter every
morning ^{searching} scrounging for ^{valuable item} gold in the
^{दूर} garbage dumps of my neighbourhood.

Saheb left his home long ago.



in middle of *স্বপ্ন*
Set amidst the green fields of Dhaka, his
home is not even a *far-away* distant memory.

There were many storms that swept
destroyed away their fields and homes, his mother
tells him. That's why they left, looking for
gold in the big city where he now lives.

বসবসানা
“I have nothing else to do,” he muttered,
looking away.



"Go to school," I say glibly, realising immediately how hollow the advice must sound.

thoughtlessly
शेवरेवला, non-sincere

"There is no school in my neighbourhood. When they build one, I will go."

"If I start a school, will you come?" I ask, half-joking.

in a funny manner
brightly
"Yes," he says, smiling broadly.



A few days later I see him running
up to me. "Is your school ready?"

"It takes longer to build a school," I
say, embarrassed at having made
a promise that was not meant. But
promises like mine abound in every
corner of his bleak world.



“SAHEB-E-ALAM”

After months of knowing him, I ask him his name. “Saheb-e-Alam,” he announces. He does not know what it means. If he knew its meaning — lord of the universe — he would have a hard time believing it.



Unaware of what his name
represents, he ^{ਘੁਮਨਾ} roams the streets with
his friends, an army of ^{ਜੰਗੀ ਪੈਰ} barefoot boys
who appear like the morning birds
^{ਜਾਪਕ} and disappear at noon. Over the
months, I have come to ^{ਪਛ-ਪਾਜਨਾ} recognise
each of them.



“Why aren’t you wearing chappals?” I ask one.

“My mother did not bring them down from the अलमारी shelf,” he answers simply.

“Even if she did he will throw them off,” adds another who is wearing shoes that do not match. moves randomly
When I comment on it, he shuffles his feet and says nothing. “I want shoes,” says a third boy who has never owned a pair all his life. Travelling across the country I have seen children walking barefoot, in cities, on village roads.



“My mother did not bring them down from the shelf.”

“Even if she did he will throw them off,” adds up quickly to add.

“I want shoes.”

रिवाज

It is not lack of money but a tradition

to stay barefoot, is one explanation. I

हैरत

wonder if this is only an excuse to

बहाना

explain away a continuous perpetual state of

गरीबी

poverty.



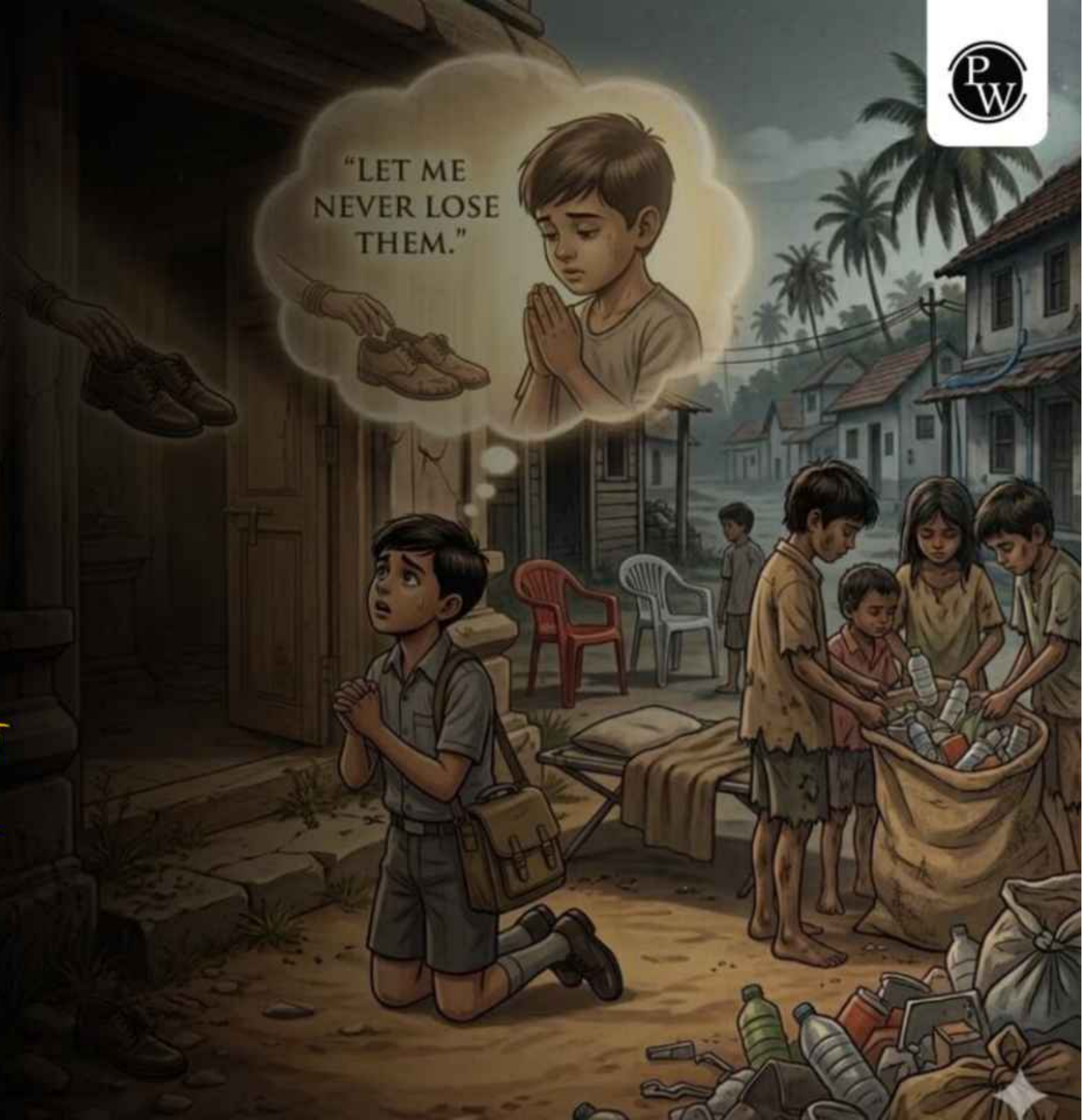
I remember a story a man from
Udipi once told me. As a young boy
he would go to school *in front of* past an old
temple, where his father was a
पुजारी *shortly* priest. He would stop briefly at the
temple and pray for a pair of
shoes.



Thirty years later I visited his town and
the temple, which was now drowned in
loneliness
an air of desolation. In the backyard,
where lived the new priest, there were
red and white plastic chairs. A young
boy dressed in a grey uniform, wearing
socks and shoes, arrived panting and
threw his school bag on a folding bed.



Looking at the boy, I remembered the prayer another boy had made to the female god ; देवी goddess when he had finally got a pair of shoes, "Let me never lose them." The goddess had accepted granted his prayer. Young boys like the son of the priest now wore कूड़ा बिनने shoes. But many others like the ragpickers in my neighbourhood remain shoeless.



Q1. What is the main activity Saheb is involved in every morning?

- A) Going to school
- B) Playing with friends
- ☒ C) Scrounging for gold in the garbage dumps
- D) Helping his mother at home

Q2. Saheb wants to go ^{to} school [^]_____.

- A) after his garbage picking job
- B) when the school comes to his place
- C) when child labour is abolished
- ☒ D) when the author starts a school

Q3. Why did Saheb and his family leave their home in Dhaka?

- A) They wanted to explore new places
- ✓ B) Storms swept away their fields and homes
- C) They were invited to the big city
- D) They were in search of better educational opportunities

Q5. 'Perpetual state of poverty' means -

- A) away from poverty
- B) living in poverty
- ☒ C) living in poverty for a long time-and continue to do so
- D) living in the neighbourhood of slums and watching people living in poverty

Q6. What does the narrator question about the tradition of staying barefoot?

- ☒ **A)** Whether it is actually a choice or a result of poverty
- B)** If it makes them stronger
- C)** Whether it is a health practice
- D)** If it signifies freedom

परिचय

My acquaintance with the barefoot

ragpickers leads me to Seema Puri, a place

edge; border

on the periphery of Delhi yet miles away

Symbolically

from it, metaphorically. Those who live here

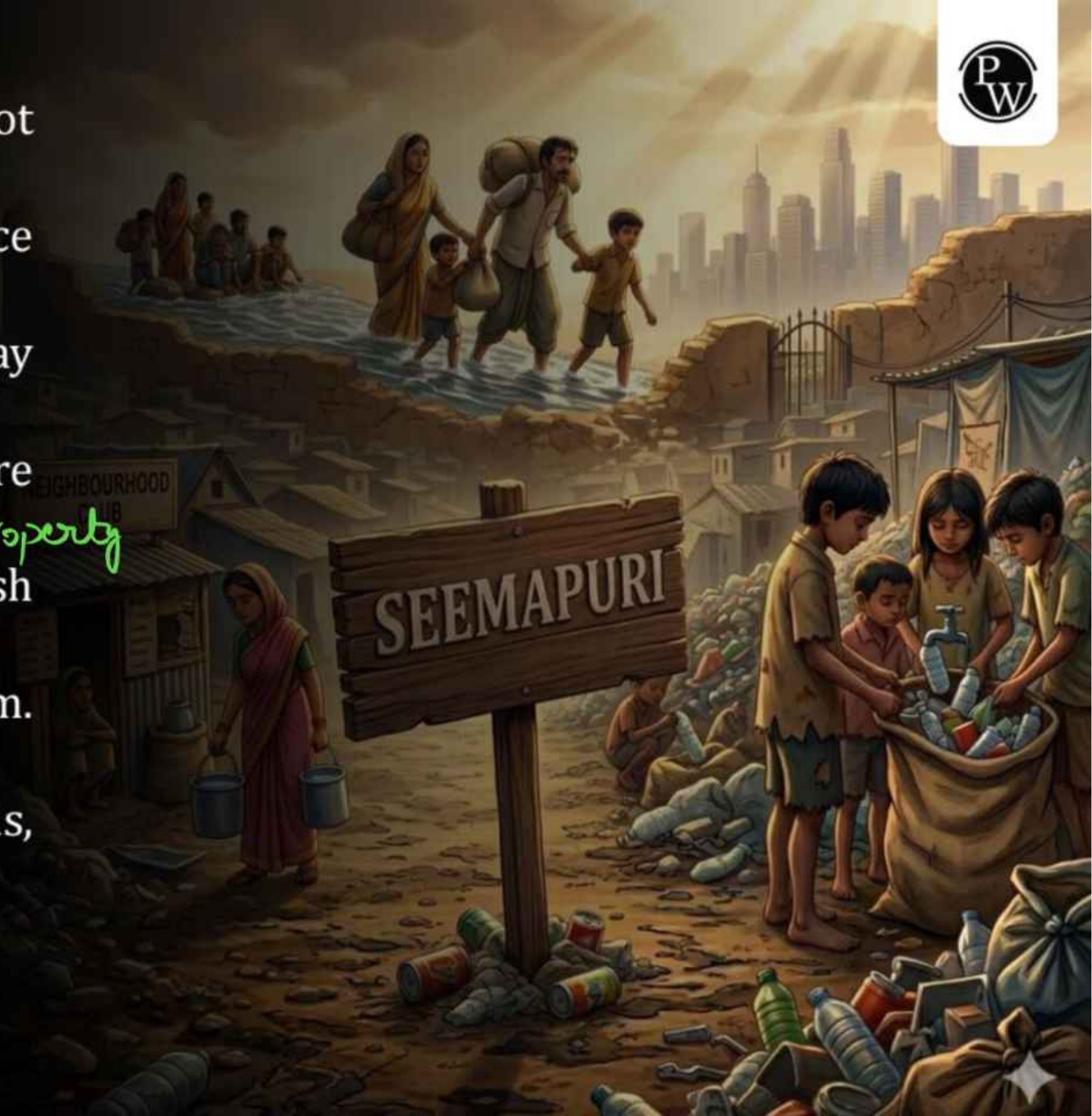
a person who lives illegally on a public property
are squatters who came from Bangladesh

back in 1971. Saheb's family is among them.

वर्तमान

Seema Puri was then a wilderness. It still is,

but it is no longer empty.



In structures of mud, with roofs of tin and tarpaulin, devoid of waste materials, sewage, drainage or running water, live **10,000 ragpickers**.



They have lived here for more than
thirty years without an identity,
without permission permits but with ration
cards that get their names on
voters' lists and enable them to
अनाज buy grain. Food is more important
for survival than an identity.



“If at the end of the day we can ^{to give food} feed our families and go to bed without an ^{pain} aching stomach, we would rather live here than in the fields that gave us no grain,” say a group of women in ^{toon; फटा हुआ} tattered saris when I ask them why they left their beautiful land of green fields and rivers. ^{event; जगह} Wherever they find food, they pitch their tents that become ^{temporary} transit homes. Children grow up in them, becoming partners in survival.



And survival in Seemapuri means

rag-picking. Through the years, it
has gained *the equivalence of a*
acquired the proportions of a

good skill
fine art. Garbage to them is gold. It

is their daily bread, a roof over their
heads, even if it is a leaking roof. But
for a child it is even more.



"I sometimes find a rupee, even a ten-rupee note," Saheb says, his eyes *shining* lighting up. When you can find a silver coin in a heap of garbage, you don't stop scrounging, for there is hope of finding more.

It seems that for children, garbage has a meaning different from what it means to their parents. For the children it is *covered* wrapped in *surprise* wonder, for the elders it is a means of survival.

daily bread



One winter morning I see Saheb standing
by the fenced ^{boundary} gate of the neighbourhood
club, watching two young men dressed in
white, playing tennis. "I like the game,"
he ^{हमसुनि-ही} hums, ^{satisfied} content to watch it standing
behind the fence. "I go inside when no
one is around," he admits. "The
gatekeeper lets me use the swing." ^{मूला}



Saheb too is wearing tennis shoes that look strange over his discoloured shirt and shorts.

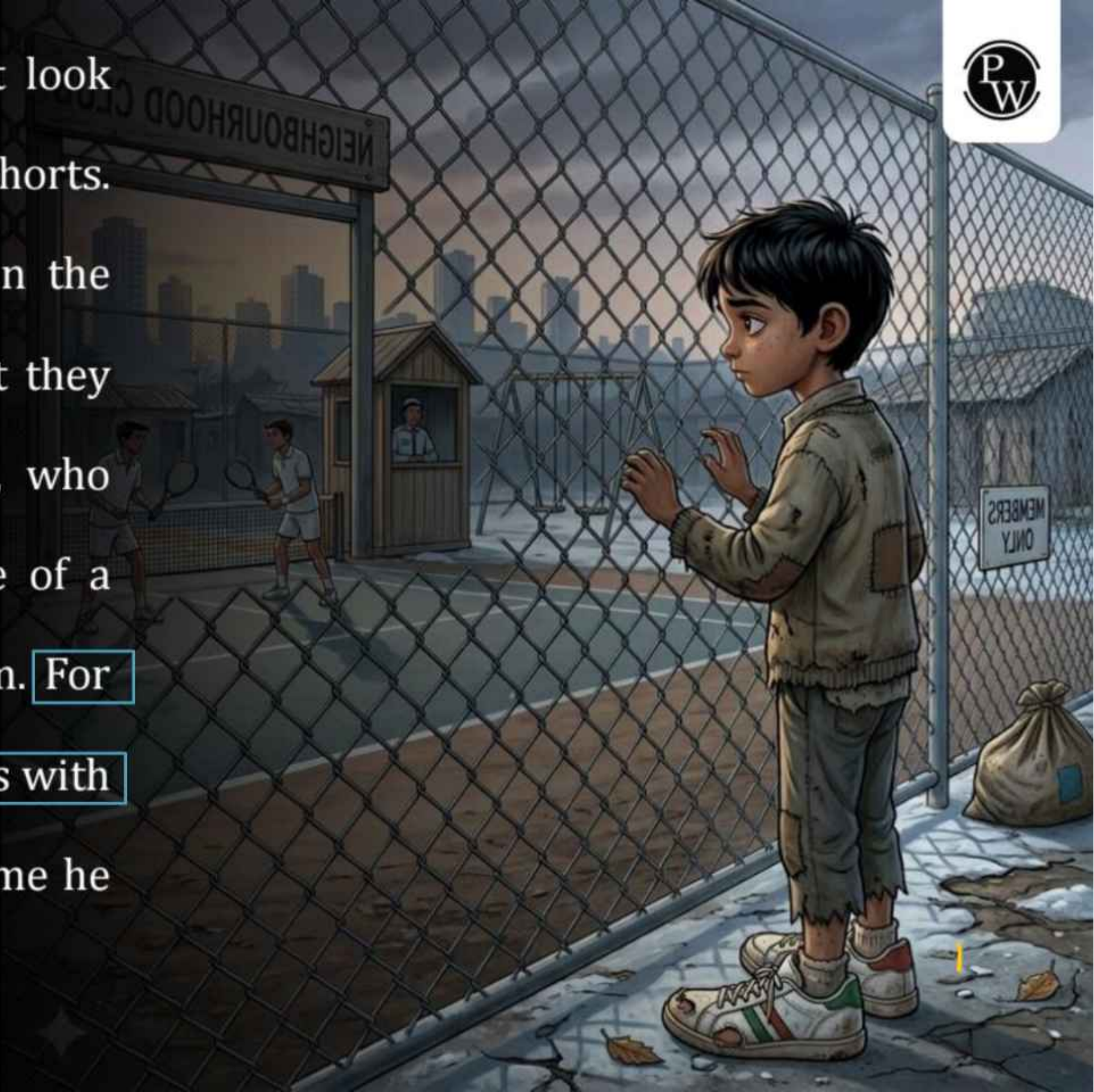
“Someone gave them to me,” he says in the manner of an explanation. The fact that they are waste ; thrown away discarded shoes of some rich boy, who perhaps refused to wear them because of a worries hole in one of them, doesn't bother him. For

one who has walked barefoot, even shoes with

a hole is a dream come true. But the game he

is watching so intently is out of his reach.

attentively



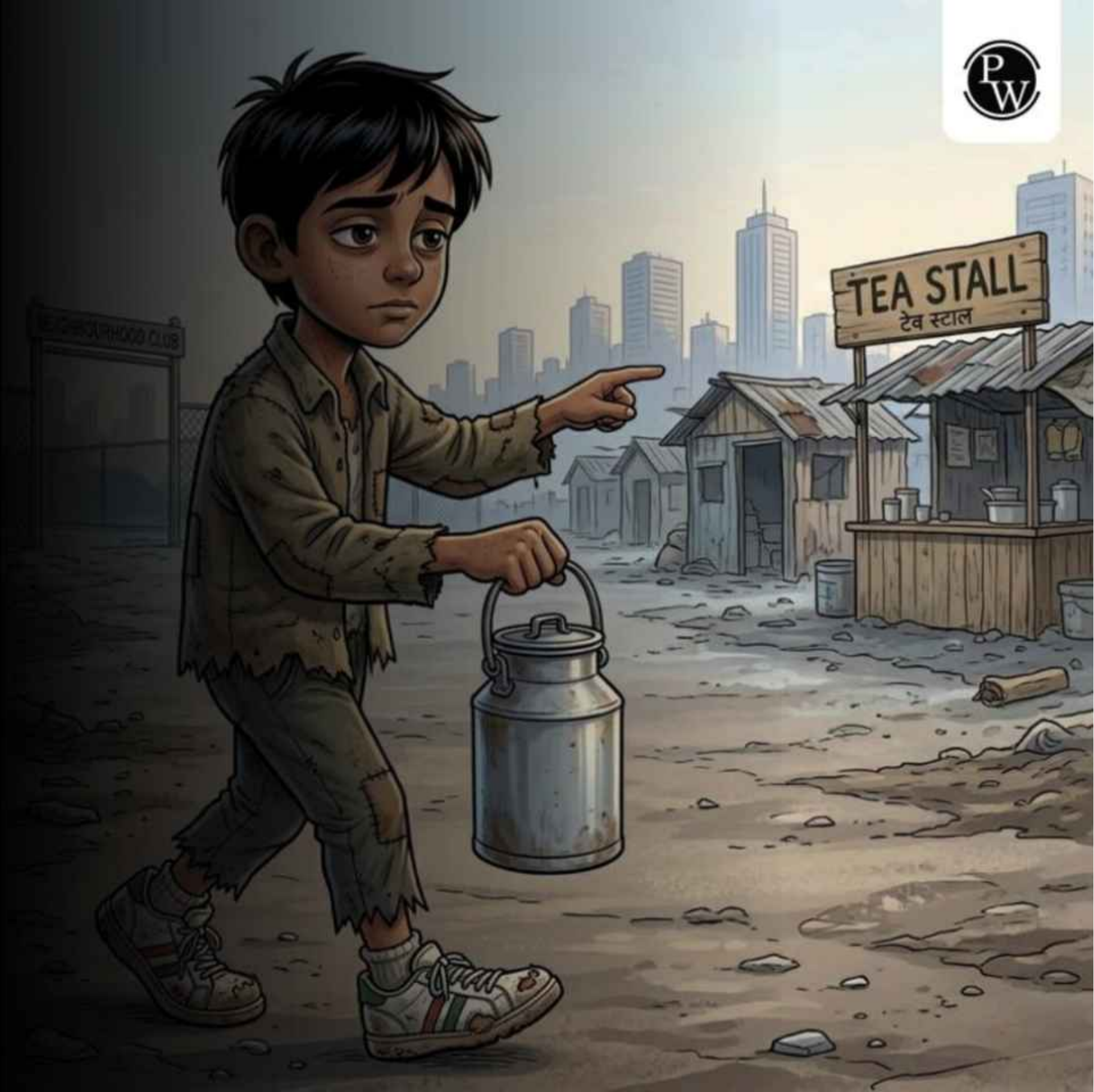
This morning, Saheb is on his way to the milk booth. In his hand is a

steel ^{container} canister. "I now work in a tea stall ^{across} down the road," he says,

^{इशारा} pointing in the distance. "I am paid

800 rupees and all my meals."

Does he like the job? I ask.



His face, I see, has lost the carefree look. The steel canister seems heavier than the plastic bag he would carry *easily* so lightly over his shoulder. The bag was his. The canister belongs to the man who owns the tea shop. Saheb is no longer his own master!



Q.1 Why does the author say, “Garbage to them is gold”?

- A) It is used by them to decorate their homes.
- ✓ B) It provides them with a primary source of livelihood.
- C) It contains precious metals and jewels.
- D) It is considered sacred in their culture.

Q.2 What kind of structures do the ragpickers in Seemapuri live in?

- A) Concrete houses
- B) Wooden cottages
- ☒ C) Mud structures with tin and tarpaulin roofs
- D) High-rise apartments

Q3. 'Periphery of Delhi' denotes -

- A) centre of Delhi
- B) far away from Delhi
- ☒ C) outskirts of Delhi
- D) near Delhi

Q4.How is the name of the poor ragpicker 'Saheb-e-Alam' ironic in nature?

- A) It suggests he is wealthy and powerful, which he is not.
- B) It indicates he is a king, but he actually works as a painter.
- C) It implies he has a large family, but he is an orphan.
- D) It shows he is highly educated, but he never went to school.

'But promises like mine abound in every corner of his bleak world'. This suggests that **(CBSE Question Bank 2021)**

- ☒ **A)** there is no scarcity of promises which remain unfulfilled.
- B)** there is a scarcity of people promising things for betterment.
- C)** people make a lot of promises which are often fulfilled.
- D)** promises made, live up to the expectations of people.

How does Saheb feel about his new job at the tea stall compared to rag-picking?



- A) Happier and more content
- ✓ B) Less carefree and burdened
- C) Excited and enthusiastic
- D) Indifferent and detached

Key Notes



SOMETIMES I FIND A RUPEE IN THE GARBAGE

Author's encounter with Saheb

- meets ragpicker Saheb, belonging to a refugee family from Bangladesh
- questions him about his vocation of picking rags, and advises him to go to school
- Saheb complains of lack of opportunity and absence of any school in his neighbourhood.



SOMETIMES I FIND A RUPEE IN THE GARBAGE

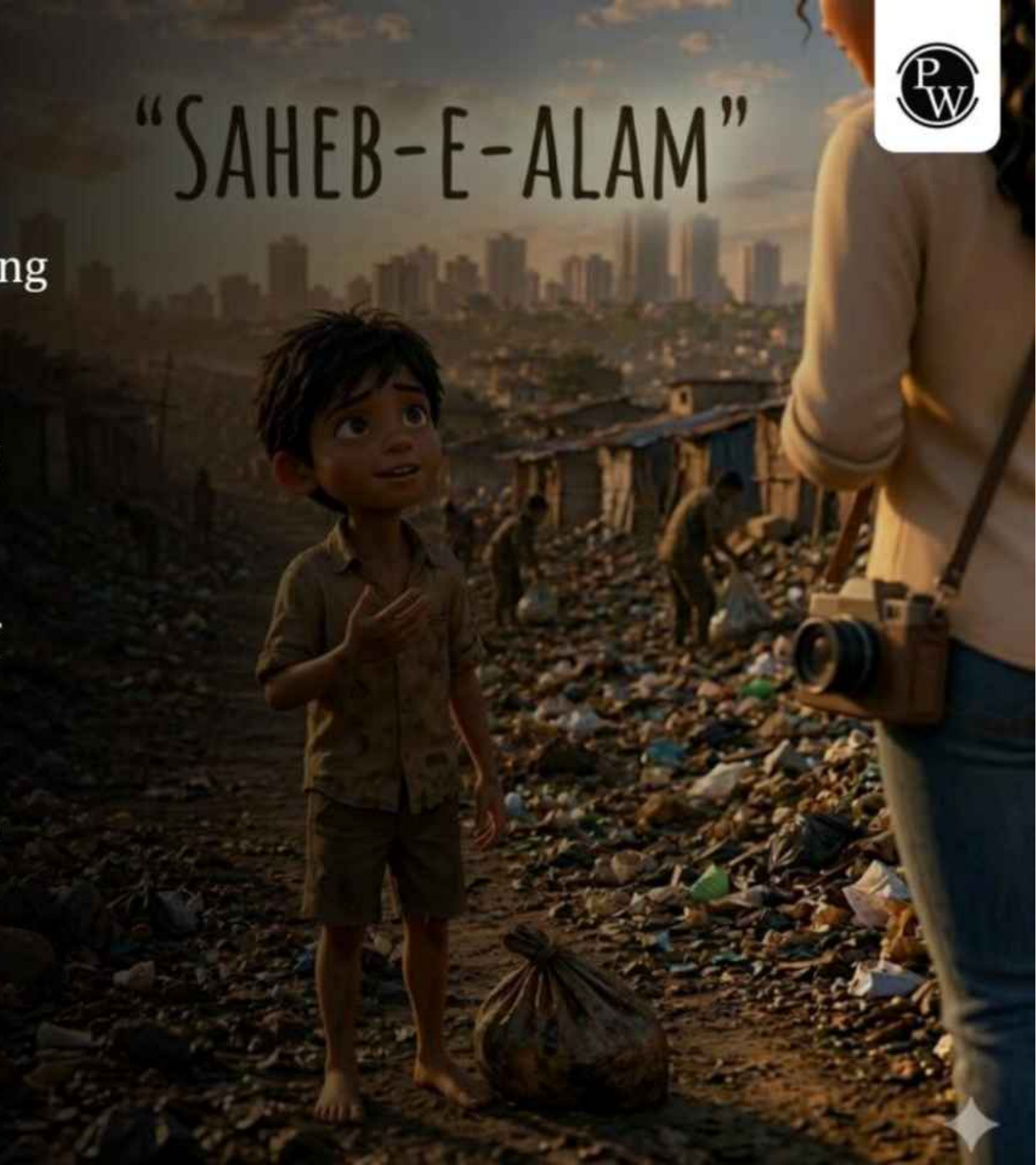
- Author raises Saheb's hope of receiving education by promising to open a school in his neighbourhood
- feels embarrassed at making a promise that she can not keep



Irony in name and existence

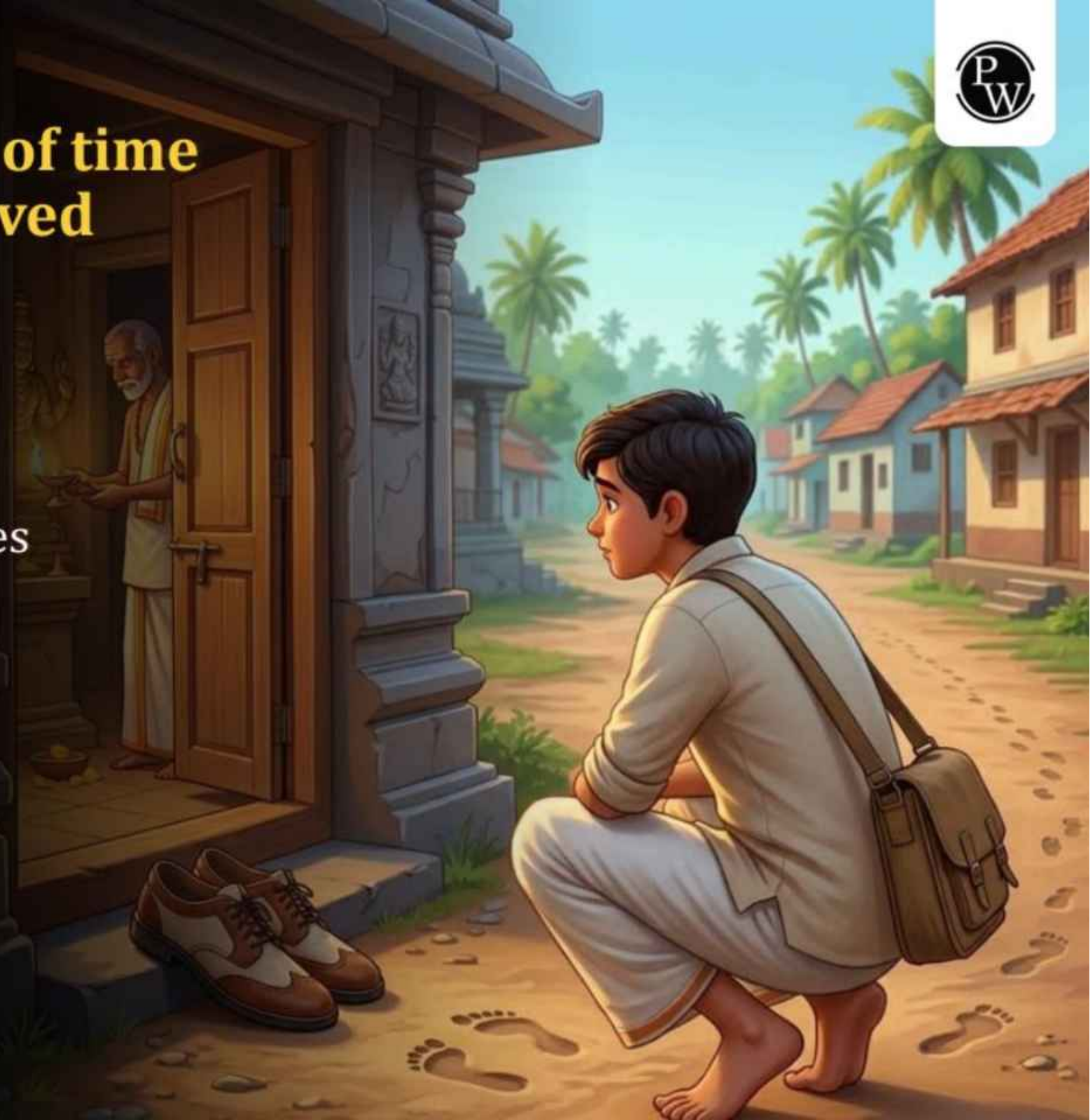
- ragpicker's full name: 'Saheb-e-Alam' meaning 'lord of the universe'
- but he spends time roaming and scrounging streets with other ragpicker boys
- all boys barefoot, reflecting extreme state of poverty
- author observes that being barefoot is more due to poverty but has been accepted as an old Indian tradition

"SAHEB-E-ALAM"



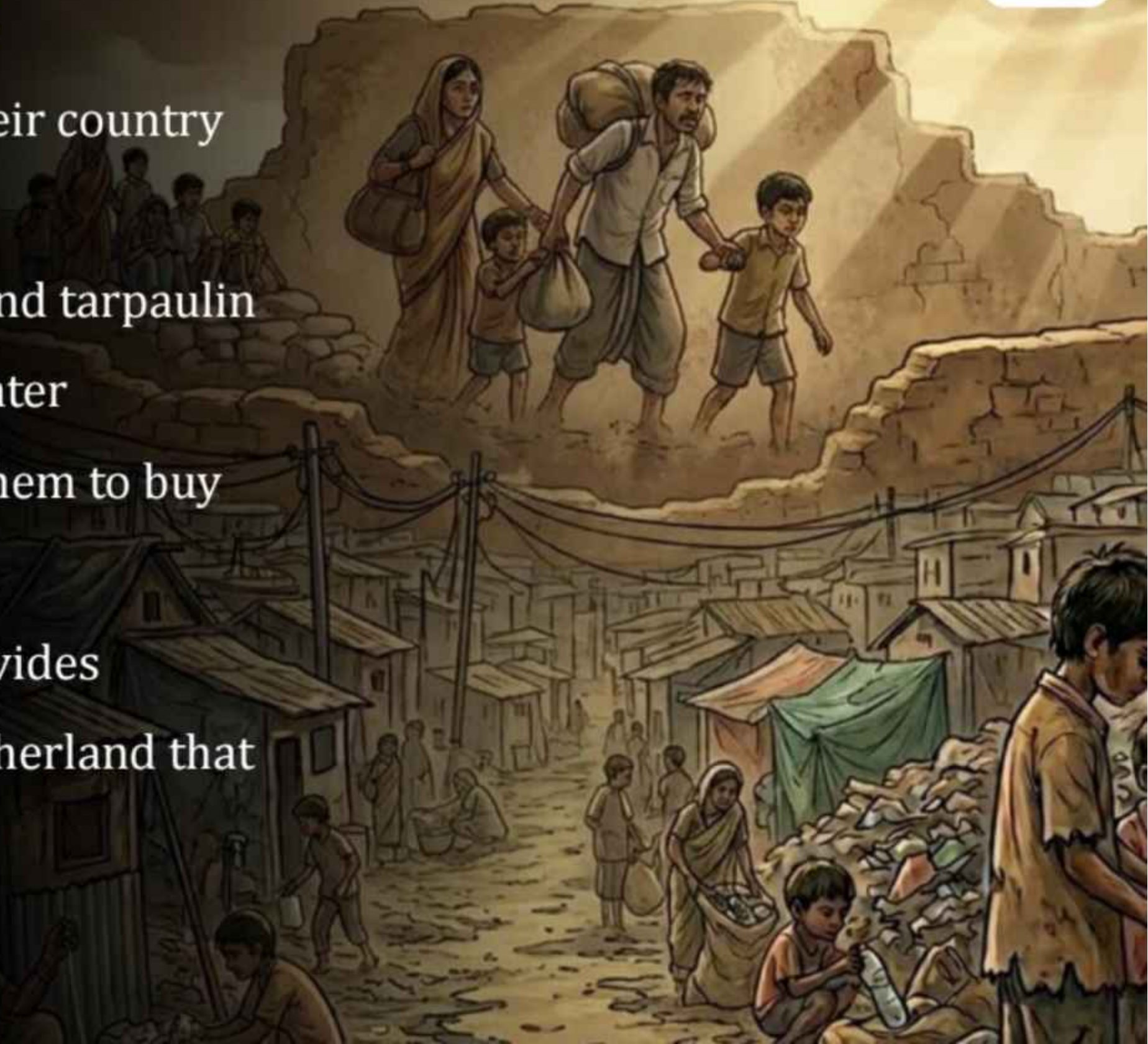
Author's reflection on passage of time and degree of prosperity achieved

- reminded of a priest's barefoot son in town of Udipi thirty years ago
- boy's fervent wish to own a pair of shoes
- thirty years later only a degree of prosperity visible
- present day priest's son now wears shoes but ragpickers are still shoeless



Ragpickers' abode Seema Puri

- most refugees are Bangladeshis; fled their country in 1971
- their dwellings: structures of mud, tin and tarpaulin with no sewage, drainage or running water
- only boon: valid ration cards enabling them to buy grain
- happy to live in an alien land which provides foodgrain than in the fields of their motherland that provides nothing



Ragpickers' abode Seema Puri

- picking garbage is the sole means of survival; earns them their daily bread, and provides roof over their heads
- a chance rupee note or coin in garbage sustains hope and life in children



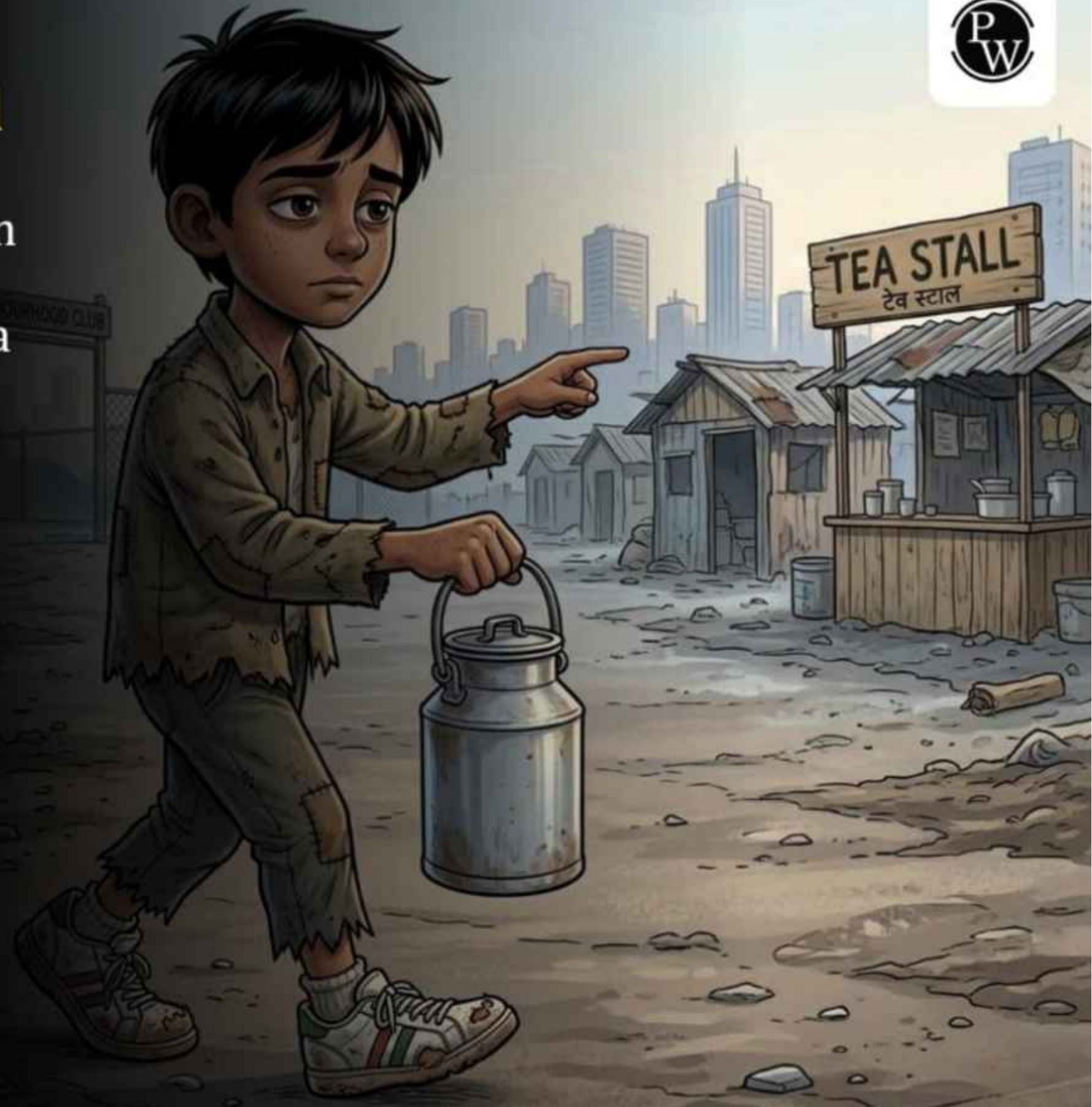
Ragpickers' abode Seema Puri

- to be comfortably off, enjoy pleasures of childhood
- play tennis, wear shoes



Saheb's conflicting step forward

- picks a job in a tea-stall; earns Rs 800/-pm
- encounters author while fetching milk in a steel canister for tea-stall owner
- appears burdened and forlorn
- no more a free bird and a master of his own self
- now a bonded labour with surrendered freedom



Topic: Glossary



- Encounter - meet by chance
- Scrounging - searching for something, especially in a haphazard or disorganized fashion
- Amidst - in the middle of; among
- Mutters - grumbles
- Glibly - without showing much thought
- Hollow - (here) not sincere
- Abound - exist in great numbers
- Bleak - (of a situation) not encouraging

- **Shuffles his feet** - moves his feet in an awkward or
- **Perpetual** - embarrassed way
- **Desolation** - continuous (here) the state of a place that is ruined or destroyed
- **Panting** - breathing quickly with short breaths, usually with one's mouth open
- **Acquaintance** - slight friendship
- **Periphery** - the outer edge of a particular area
- **Metaphorically** - virtually; symbolically as opposed to literally

- **Squatters** - persons who live on land without permission and without paying rent
- **Wilderness** – undeveloped area of land
- **Devoid** - completely lacking in something
- **Aching** - paining
- **Tattered** - old and torn
- **Pitch their tents** - set up their tents for a short time
- **Transit homes** - homes that provide temporary accommodation for refugees

- **Hums** - sings a tune with his lips closed
- **Discarded** - rejected; no longer used
- **Intently** - attentively; with great interest
- **Canister** - a container with a lid for holding tea, milk etc.

SECTION A

- ✓ Q. What is Saheb looking for in the garbage dumps? Where is he and where has he come from?
- ✓ Q. What explanations does the author offer for the children not wearing footwear?
- ✓ Q. Is Saheb happy working at the tea-stall? Explain.
- ✓ Q. What could be some of the reasons for the migration of people from villages to cities?
- ✓ Q. Would you agree that promises made to poor children are rarely kept? Why do you think this happens in the incidents narrated in the text?
- ✓ Q. What forces conspire to keep the workers in the bangle industry of Firozabad in poverty? ✓

Q1. The description of Seemapuri creates a very dismal picture. Explain. (CBSE 2023)

Q2. ✓ What explanation did the children offer the writer for not wearing footwear? Did she agree to it? (CBSE 2020)

Q3. ✓ For Saheb, how was work at the tea stall different from rag picking? ☆ (CBSE 2020)

Q4. ✓ How was Saheb's life at the tea-stall? ☆ (CBSE 2020)

The description of Seemapuri creates a very dismal picture. Explain.

(CBSE 2023)

The given statement stands true as Seemapuri, though exists at the periphery of Delhi, is very far from it in terms of facilities and opportunities. It is a home to poverty stricken ragpickers who live together in slums without any proper sanitation or drainage facilities and without any educational or employment opportunities.

What explanation did the children offer the writer for not wearing footwear? Did she agree to it?

(CBSE 2020)

The children offers various explanations to the writer for not wearing footwear like, they did not want to take the trouble of taking their slippers down from the shelf, not wearing footwear is a tradition in their culture and so on.

For Saheb, how was work at the tea stall different from rag picking?

(CBSE 2020)

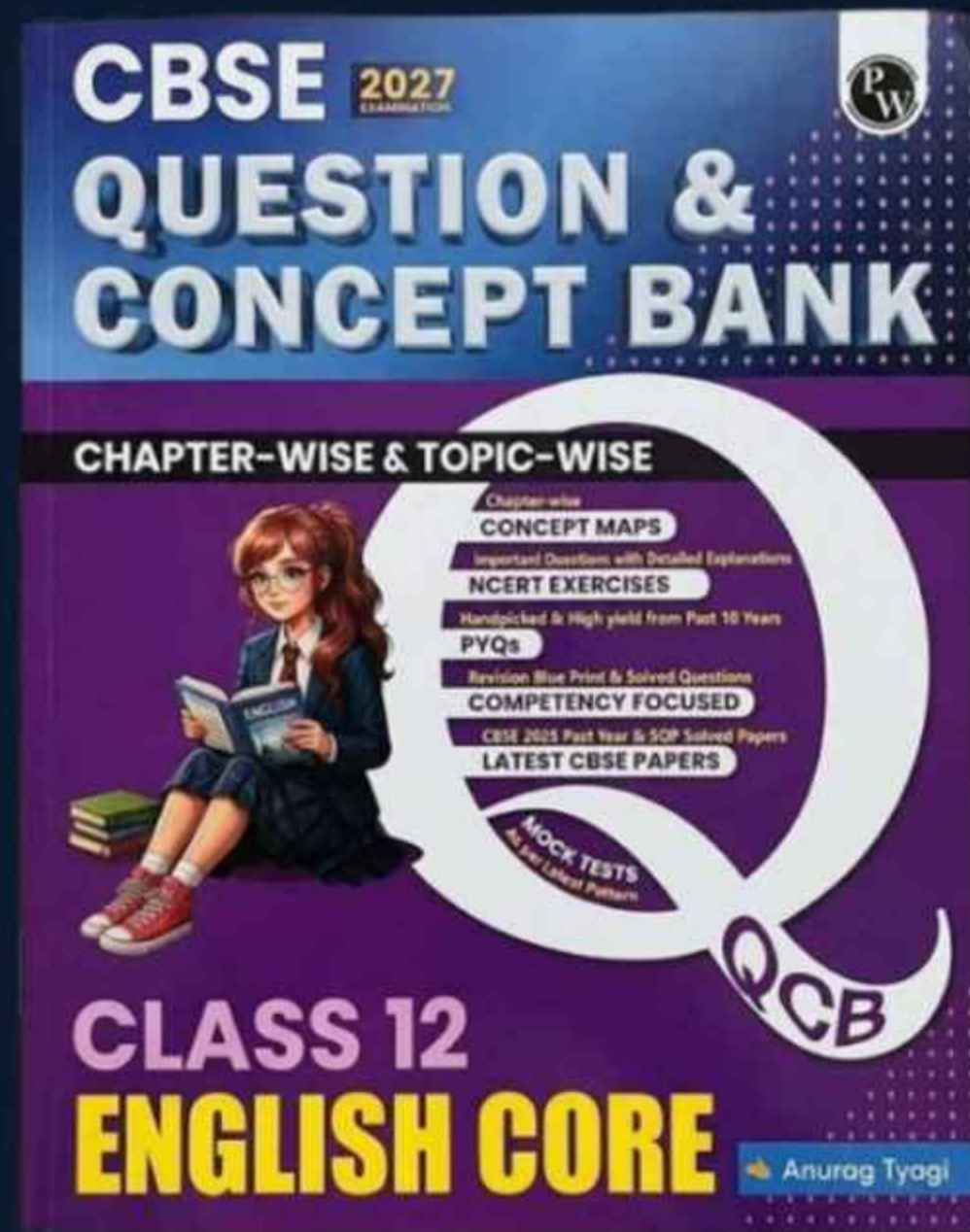
When Saheb started working at the tea stall, his face lost the carefree look which he used to have when he was a ragpicker. He was no longer his own master now. He had to do what the owner of the tea stall asked him to do. He carried heavy metal canisters, instead of light plastic bags. He was not happy working at the tea stall as he had lost his freedom.

How was Saheb's life at the tea-stall?

(CBSE 2020)

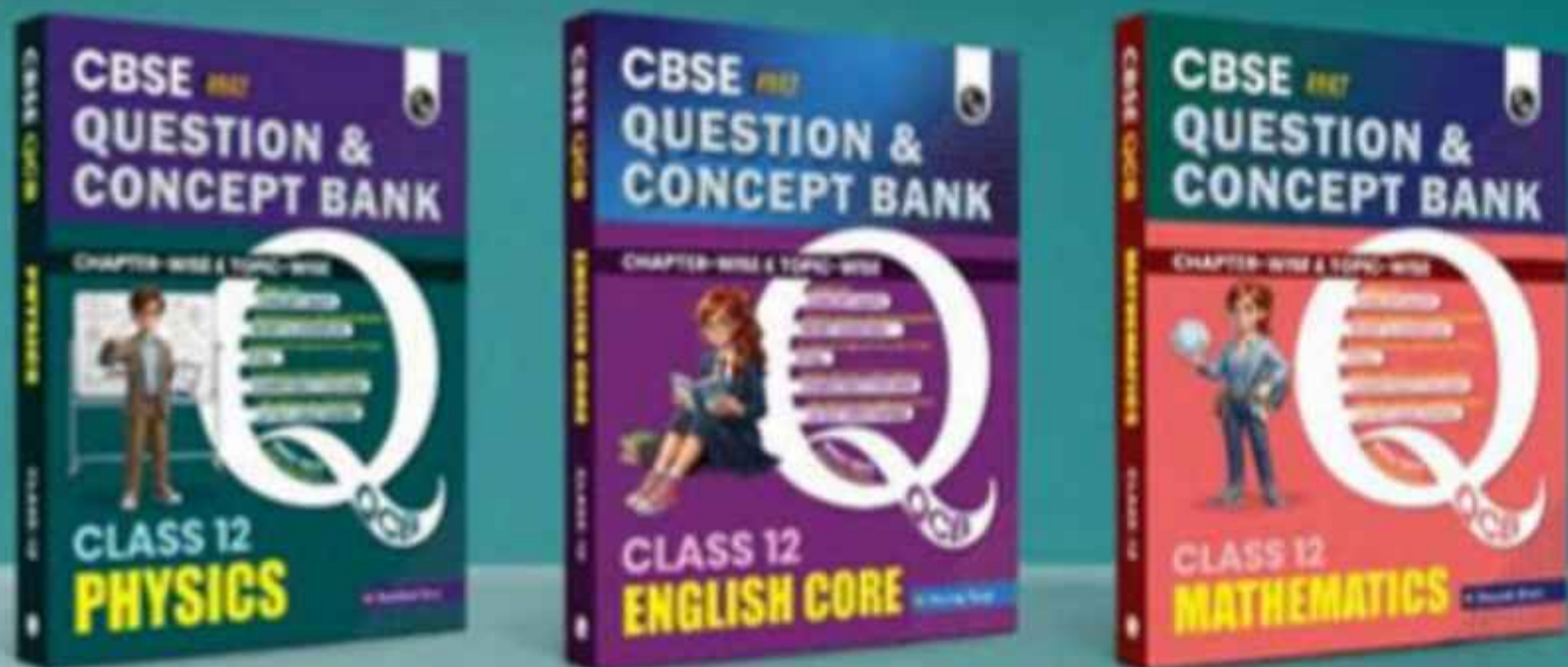
Saheb took up the job of performing odd jobs at a tea stall, but was unhappy because he was tied down by the work he had to do. Thus, he lost his independence, which he earlier had as a ragpicker.

English Sample Question Paper



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Thank you!